MIL-STD-1433
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MILITARY STANDARD

CLIMBER SETS, TREE AND POLE

FSC 4240

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE
Washington, D. C. 20301

Climber Sets, Tree and Pole

MIL-STD-1433

1. This Military Standard is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense, to assure that selection of new items is limited to essential items, for which no comparable standard item exists. This document is not intended to restrict any service in selecting new items required to support state-of-the-art changes.

2. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to Commanding Officer, Edgewood Arsenal, ATTN: SMUEA-TSE-SM, Edgewood Arsenal, Maryland 21010

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FOREWORD

This is the first book format standard generated on tree and pole climber sets. This standard is mandatory for use by all departments and agencies of the Department of Defense in the selection of items for application. It is intended to prevent the entry of unnecessary items (sizes, types, varieties) into the Department of Defense Logistics System. This is not a procurement document. This document is not intended to restrict any service in selecting new items required to support state-of-the-art changes.

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Coverage. This standard is a presentation of nomenclature, military and typical commercial uses, directions for use, packaging data, general safety precautions, storage information and shelf life of all military standard climber sets. This standard does not necessarily include all classifications of the items represented by the title or those which are commercially available. It does contain a typical climber set of the design and type preferred by the Department of Defense. This standard covers the following items and components:

Name	Fig. No.
1. Climber Set, Tree and Pole	1
2. Leg Iron	2
3. Pole Gaff	3
4. Tree Gaff	4
5. Ankle Strap	5
6. Calf Strap	6
7. Calf Pad	7

1.2 Application. Items listed herein accomodate essential requirements of the military defense agencies, and will affect continued economics in all logistics functions when properly employed in new applications.

2. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS

The issues of the following documents in effect on the date of invitations for bid form a part of this standard to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification RR-C-430	Climber Set, Tree and Pole; Steel, Interchangeable Gaff, w/Nylon-Neoprene Coated Straps
Military Standard MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking of US Military Property
Commercial Specification Edison Electric Institute	(EEIS) AP-2-Specifications for Lineman's Climbing Equipment

3.1 Definitions.

Impregnated - Infused or permeated throughout; saturated.

Neoprene - A type of synthetic polymer with rubber-like characteristics.

Ambient - Surrounding

Cool Limits - From above freezing to 110° Fahrenheit.

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4. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Marking. The climber set shall be permanently and clearly marked with the manufacturer's name, or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily identified, or in accordance with MIL-STD-130 when solely intended for military use.

4.2 Safety. Components of climber sets shall be utilized for the intended purpose only. Straps and pads should be kept away from steam pipes or other similar heat sources. In the event they become wet, they should be dried at ambient temperatures, without the aid of artificial heat. Persons wearing the straps should note any signs of mildew, burns, or cracks as signs of wear. When these signs are in evidence, straps should be discarded. For straps in normal use, visual inspection should be made prior to each usage. Straps in continuous use should be discarded after five years. Only general safety precautions are outlined in this standard. For more specific information see other publications such as Edison Electric Institute Specification (EEIS) AP2. Gaffs should be sharpened by using a sharp smooth file, never on any kind of a grinding wheel as this is apt to spoil the temper and make gaff dangerous to use. Specific instructions on checking sharpness of gaff and method of sharpening shall be included on instruction sheet inclosed with climber set.

4.3 Storage data. Climber sets should be stored, in a cool dry area. Shelf life for climber sets is indefinite, providing temperature range of storage area is within cool limits.

4.4 Interchangeability. All component parts, namely pole gaffs, tree gaffs, leg irons, ankle strap, calf strap and calf pad of the same manufacturers item shall be of the same shape, dimensions and design so that components may be interchanged without loss of effectiveness of the pole climber set or impairing their intended use.

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5. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Name. CLIMBER SET, TREE AND POLE

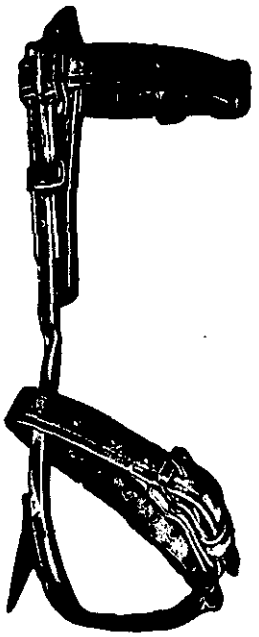


Figure 1. - Typical illustration of a Climber Set, Tree and Pole

5.1.1 Specification. RR-C-430, Climber Set, Tree and Pole, Steel, Interchangeable Gaff, w/Nylon - Neoprene Coated Straps.

5.1.2 Technical Description. The climber set shall conform to the typical type depicted in figure 1, the straps conform to figures 5 and 6, and the calf pad conform to figure 7. The leg iron shall be adjustable from 14-3/4 to 19-1/4 inches in increments of 1/4 inch. One set of pole gaffs and one set of tree gaffs shall be furnished with each climber set, and gaffs shall be interchangeable. Climber sets shall consist of a right and left leg iron.

5.1.3 Use data. Climber sets are intended for use in ascending or descending trees and poles.

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5.1.4 Packaging data. Climber sets shall be packaged and packed in accordance with RR-C-430.

5.1.5 Safety precautions. Packaging shall afford adequate protection from hazards of contamination and physical damage encountered in general handling, shelf storage and issue of climber sets.

5.1.6 Storage data. See 4.3

5.2 Name. LEG IRON (Shank)

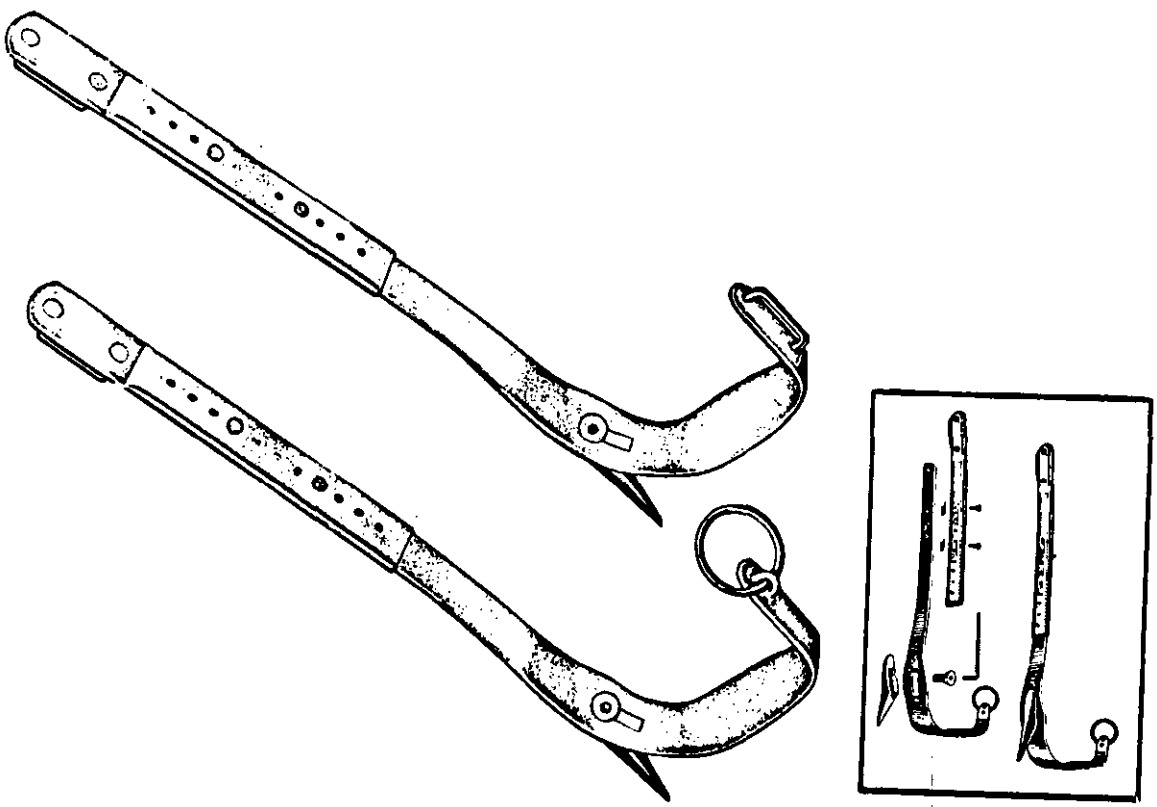


Figure 2. - Typical illustration of Leg Irons, with gaffs and locking screws

5.2.1 Specification. RR-C-430

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5.2.2 Technical description. Leg irons shall be of forged steel, be adjustable from 14-3/4 to 19-1/4 inches in increments of 1/4 inch, and shall consist of two parts secured by screws, steel pins with keepers, or any infallible device similar to those depicted in figures 1 and 2. A ring for fastening the ankle straps and a loop for the calf strap to pass through shall be riveted to the leg iron. Leg irons shall be made in matched pairs for wearing on the right and left legs.

5.2.3 Use data. Used as a component of climber sets.

5.2.4 Packaging. See 5.1.4

5.2.5 Safety precautions. Manufacturer shall include instruction sheet to recommend leg iron being replaced upon usage of a specified number of gaff sets. If locking screw requires special key, cotter key, or similar keeping device, this device shall be included with leg iron.

5.2.6 Storage data. See 4.3

5.3 Name. GAFF, POLE

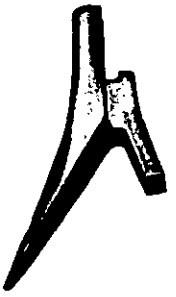


Figure 3. - Typical illustration of a pole gaff

5.3.1 Specification. RR-C-430

5.3.2 Technical description. Pole gaffs shall be of forged steel, conform to shape in figure 3 with an underside length of 1-7/16 inches minimum to 2-1/2 inches maximum. Pole gaffs shall be interchangeable with tree gaffs on the leg iron of climber sets.

5.3.3 Use data. Pole gaffs shall be used on climber sets when climbing poles.

5.3.4 Packaging. See 5.1.4

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5.3.5 Safety precautions. A locking screw shall fasten gaff to leg iron and gaff shall have an aligning device. In use, full impact is to be absorbed by leg iron and gaff. No load is to be absorbed by locking screw. Method of sharpening gaff shall be on instruction sheet inclosed with climber sets, to insure maximum safety. Any special key or locking device shall be inclosed with gaffs.

5.3.6 Storage data. See 4.3

5.4 Name. GAFF, TREE

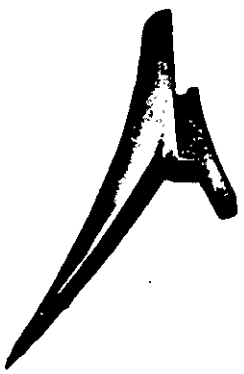


Figure 4. - Typical illustration of a tree gaff

5.4.1 Specification. RR-C-430

5.4.2 Technical Description. Tree gaffs shall be of forged steel, conform to shape in figure 4, with an underside length of 2-3/4 inches minimum to 3-1/2 inches maximum. Tree gaffs shall be interchangeable with pole gaffs on the leg iron of climber sets.

5.4.3 Use data. Tree gaffs are used on climber sets when ascending or descending trees.

5.4.4 Packaging. See 5.1.4

5.4.5 Safety precautions. See 5.3.5

5.4.6 Storage data. See 4.3

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5.5 Name. STRAP, ANKLE



Figure 5. - Typical illustration of an ankle strap

5.5.1 Specification. RR-C-430

5.5.2 Technical description. Strap shall consist of two parts, a buckle piece and a tongue piece, with both pieces riveted to ring on leg iron as depicted in figure 5. Strap fabric shall consist of four plies of nylon cloth of 50 by 25 thread count impregnated with neoprene and vulcanized. Holes shall be punched in tongue piece for buckling and buckle shall have a pad under it for comfort. Tongue piece shall have a foldover of 2 inches for holding ring with one rivet 1-1/2 inches from foldover end and one rivet as close to ring as possible. Buckle piece shall be of 3 plies of strap 3-1/2 inches in length with one rivet in each end as close to ring and buckle as possible. Staple loop together before assembling and insert between first & second ply of buckle strap.

5.5.3 Use data. Ankle strap is used to secure leg iron to users feet.

5.5.4 Packaging. See 5.1.4

5.5.5 Safety precautions. See 4.2

5.5.6 Storage data. See 4.3

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5.6 Name. STRAP, CALF



Figure 6. - Typical illustration of a calf strap

5.6.1 Specification. RR-C-430

5.6.2 Technical description. Strap fabric shall consist of four plies of nylon cloth of 50 x 25 thread count impregnated with neoprene and vulcanized. A buckle shall be riveted to strap in a manner depicted in figure 6.

5.6.3 Use data. Calf straps shall be used to secure leg iron to users leg by passing through top loop of leg iron, loops of calf pad and buckling around calf.

5.6.4 Packaging data. See 5.1.4

5.6.5 Safety precautions. See 4.2

5.6.6 Storage data. See 4.3

5.7 Name. PAD, CALF



Right Hand Wing Pad

Figure 7. - Typical illustrations of calf pad

5.7.1 Specification. RR-C-430

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5.7.2 Technical description. Calf pad shall be of neoprene coated nylon and flexible foam vinyl and conform to shape depicted in figure 7. Pad shall be of winged type only. Loops for calf strap and leg iron shall be riveted. Winged types shall consist of a right and left hand pad furnished in pairs. For detailed construction see figure 4 of RR-C-430.

5.7.3 Use data. Calf pads add to the wearers comfort thus promoting safety and efficiency.

5.7.4 Packaging. See 5.1.4. Winged pads should be packaged in pairs.

5.7.5 Safety precautions. See 4.2

5.7.6 Storage data. See 4.3

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Preparing Activity: Army - MU

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